



Above The Rose and Crown pub in Snettisham is a traditional North Norfolk pub that offers locally sourced food, including samphire

Left At Blakeney Point, small boats take advantage of the incoming tide as it starts to fill the creeks winding through the saltmarsh



Above Tasty sausages and superb steaks from traditional, fourth-generation butcher Arthur Howell can be found on many Norfolk menus

Seasonal Produce

Cromer crabs are said to be at their finest from Good Friday onward, just in time to be eaten with buttery new potatoes and the glorious **asparagus** for which Norfolk is famed. Traditionally, the last asparagus is cut on Midsummer's Day, but before long **samphire** – a unique, salty edible plant known as “poor man’s asparagus” – comes into season. **Lavender** reflects the intense blue of Norfolk’s wide summer skies; introduced here by the Romans, its delicate flavor can be found in ice creams and sauces, and even perking up salads. Fall and winter bring a feast of **game**, including little-seen gamebirds such as teal and woodcock, and the plumpest **mussels**.

The Best Places to Eat Norfolk Pub Food

The Rose and Crown inexpensive–moderate

The Rose and Crown in the village of Snettisham, 4 miles (6 km) north of Sandringham, is an unpretentious village pub that dates back to the 14th century, and it hasn’t let its growing reputation as one of the area’s best gastropubs spoil its historic feel or its place as a village local. It serves a good selection of Norfolk and Suffolk ales, and its warren of rooms provides cozy drinking corners as well as a choice of eating areas, in among the inglenook fireplaces and red-tiled floors. There are straightforward bar meals, such as fish and chips and Holkham Hall sausages with mash, or more elaborate dishes using local produce. Samphire is harvested on the coast nearby, herbs are grown in community gardens, and seafood is bought direct from the fishermen who bring it to the pub’s kitchen early in the morning. Brancaster mussels and oysters sit on the menu alongside Norfolk pigeon breast and fresh grilled asparagus.

Old Church Road, Snettisham, Norfolk;
open for lunch and dinner daily;
www.roseandcrowsnnettisham.co.uk

Also in North Norfolk

With a few exceptions, prices vary little across the area. Food in the 17th-century **Hoste Arms** (www.hostearms.co.uk; *moderate*) on Burnham Market’s village green is exceptional. Meats come from the Great Ryburgh Farm, venison from Holkham Hall, and oysters from nearby Burnham Creek. With stunning coastal views, the **White Horse** in Brancaster (www.whitehorsebrancaster.co.uk; *moderate*) has exceptional shellfish, from the beds at the shore of their property. Another **White Horse**, in the iconic village of Blakeney (www.blakeneywhitehorse.co.uk; *moderate*), is an old coaching inn that fields an impressive range of local suppliers on its menu: look for Morston mussels, Firs Farm lamb, Binham Blue cheese, and beer from microbrewery Yetmans.

Also in England

Heston Blumenthal is just one of several celebrity chefs now running gastropubs, and one of them, **The Hinds Head** in Bray, Berkshire (www.hindsheadhotel.co.uk; *expensive*), was recently chosen as “Pub of the Year” by the inspectors for Michelin.

Also in the UK

A few miles outside Edinburgh in Lothianbridge, Dalkeith, is the Scottish Gastropub of the Year, the **Sun Inn** (www.thesunininedinburgh.co.uk; *moderate*). With its oak floors, wooden beams, and log fires, it’s the epitome of the friendly old pub, but it uses superb produce obtained from top Scottish suppliers including Glen Lyon venison, Macsween haggis, Isle of Mull cheddar, and Strathdon blue cheese.